

Amazon Web Services

# Digital Sovereignty

Messaging and Positioning Framework (MPF)

Amazon Web Services (AWS)

**What:** A messaging narrative that describes the combined value of AWS and AWS Partners for Digital Sovereignty.

**Audience:** AWS Partners

**How to use this document:** As an AWS Partner, you can use the messaging in this document to explain to customers the joint value of your unique offering with AWS. This document includes messaging that explains how AWS and AWS Partner Digital Sovereignty solutions benefit customers. Use this information to effectively co-brand, target the right audiences, and go-to-market with AWS.

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## Executive Summary

This messaging guide provides customer-ready copy for AWS Partners to use in their marketing and communications materials. It outlines how AWS sovereign-by-design solutions can help customers meet their unique digital sovereignty requirements within the European Union (EU), including ‘reasons to believe’ to substantiate all messaging claims. This document also provides an overview of the digital sovereignty market landscape, target customer segments, business and technical decision maker pain points, tenets, and messaging best practices.

## Market Landscape

Meeting digital sovereignty requirements is a balancing act for many organizations that operate within the EU, especially for those in the public sector and in highly regulated industries. They need to adhere to both EU and local country laws and regulations and require additional assurances in the areas of data residency, operational autonomy, and resilience, all while driving ongoing innovation to deliver for those they serve.

To maintain digital sovereignty, organizations must have strong foundational security, along with the flexibility to be able to adapt to the changing EU regulatory environment and evolving customer needs. Innovation must not come at the cost of control, and the good news is that it doesn’t have to. The cloud can provide the security, privacy, and control that organizations need, while also supporting scale, agility, and speed to innovate at pace.

Sovereignty requirements can vary based on multiple factors including location, sensitivity and classification of workloads, and industry standards. There’s no one-size-fits-all solution and that’s why having a range of options to choose from, along with the transparency and assurances needed to build confidently, is so important.

## Primary Sectors

- Government/public sector
- Financial services
- Healthcare and life sciences
- Energy and utilities
- Telecommunications

## Audiences

- Business decision makers (BDMs)
- Technical decision makers (TDMs)

## Pain Points

### BDM Audience

Organizations must maintain their competitive advantage and continuously innovate on behalf of their customers, while delivering value and driving growth for stakeholders. Business leaders need to quantify the benefits of a move to the cloud beyond infrastructure cost savings alone and understand the cloud’s ability to accelerate innovation, enhance security, increase flexibility, and manage costs. They must also

maintain stakeholder confidence in sovereign measures within a complex and changing regulatory landscape. They need to trust that the cloud systems they choose can address unique digital sovereignty needs and help mitigate any potential risks.

#### TDM Audience

Organizations must have the right tools and services to balance performance and availability with security and compliance that adhere to in-country laws, while supporting the ability to innovate, scale, and grow. For technical leaders, maintaining the organization's sovereignty posture requires being able to address the impact of newly created certification schemes, acts, and directives, verifying compliance, and defining risks for any regulatory guidelines that are non-cloud compatible. They also need to trust the cloud systems they choose can provide the high levels of resiliency needed to maintain continuity in the face of any potential disruptive events.

## Messaging Pillar 1—Sovereign by Design

### Messaging Overview

AWS is sovereign by design and provides the highest levels of security and protection, helping customers meet their evolving digital sovereignty needs. The AWS Cloud enables customers to continuously invent and innovate, while helping meet their regulatory and workload sensitivity requirements—wherever they choose to operate. This gives customers more choice and more control and allows them to optimize for increased scale, agility, speed, and reduced costs—without any compromise to the full power of the cloud.

- **Prioritizing sovereignty since day one:** AWS is sovereign by design and offers a comprehensive set of technical measures, operational controls, and legal protections that give customers control over where they locate their data, who can access it, and how it is used, while getting the full benefits of the cloud. AWS continues to work closely with regulators, cybersecurity authorities, and partners to help customers meet their unique needs and innovate within the evolving sovereignty landscape.
- **Security is foundational to digital sovereignty:** Security is and always has been a top priority for AWS. It offers the most proven operational experience, at greater scale, of any cloud provider, with a cloud and network architecture that delivers high levels of stability and fault tolerance to meet the requirements of the most security-sensitive organizations.
- **More control and choice without compromise:** AWS sovereignty capabilities are backed by its Digital Sovereignty Pledge, which is its formalized commitment to deliver the most advanced set of sovereignty controls and features available in the cloud. AWS is focused on continuing to expand its capabilities around four core pillars including data residency, granular access restriction, encryption, and resilience, and extending the AWS infrastructure continuum based on customer and partner needs.

### Short Version

Continuously innovate while meeting unique digital sovereignty needs, without compromising the power of the cloud.

### Medium Version

Invent and innovate, while meeting unique security, regulatory, and sovereignty needs, without compromising on the power of cloud.

### Long Version

AWS enables customers to continually invent and innovate while helping meet their unique digital sovereignty and security needs. Customers have more choice and control—without compromise—to meet their regulatory and sensitive workload requirements regardless of where they operate, while benefiting from the full power of the cloud.

### Reasons to Believe

#### Digital Sovereignty

Since its inception, digital sovereignty has been a priority for AWS when it was the only major cloud provider to allow customers to control the location and movement of their data. AWS offers industry-leading technical measures, operational controls, and legal protections that give customers control over where they locate their data and who can access it. The AWS approach to digital sovereignty and keeping up with customer needs as regulations evolve has led to innovations such as [AWS Dedicated Local Zones](#), an exclusive infrastructure fully managed by AWS and placed in a customer-specified location or data center to run sensitive workloads. Millions of customers around the world count on AWS, and AWS has a proven track record of global innovation that supports specialized workloads.

#### Access Control

[The AWS Nitro System](#), designed and delivered as a first-of-a-kind innovation, is the foundation of AWS confidential computing. Its specialized hardware and associated firmware are designed to enforce restrictions so that nobody, including anyone in AWS, can access customer workloads or data running on Amazon Elastic Compute Cloud (Amazon EC2) Nitro-based instances. Because the controls that help prevent operator access are so fundamental to the Nitro System, AWS has added additional assurances for AWS Nitro System EC2 instances to the [AWS Service Terms](#). AWS Nitro System security design has been independently validated by the global cybersecurity consulting firm [NCC Group](#). This supports the AWS commitment to transparency and provides assurances on how AWS services are designed and operated, helping to build and maintain customer trust.

[AWS Control Tower](#) offers more than 240 controls under a digital sovereignty group to help organizations meet regulatory compliance in the cloud under the Shared Responsibility model. These controls help customers prevent actions, enforce configurations, and detect undesirable changes that affect data residency, granular access restriction, data encryption at rest and in transit, and resilience capabilities. All controls are aligned with defined protection measures to prevent and detect deviations from data residency requirements by proactively scanning before deployments with CloudFormation guard rules. Control Tower also has enhanced region-deny capabilities that provide access restrictions to AWS APIs in unwanted regions, ensuring that resources are only provisioned in compliant AWS Regions.

#### Security and Compliance

[Security](#) is and always has been the top priority at AWS and it is foundational to digital sovereignty. Customers benefit from a cloud and network architecture that has been built to satisfy the security requirements for the highest-sensitivity organizations, including government, healthcare, and financial

services. AWS offers over 300 [security, compliance, and governance services and features](#), and supports more than 140 [security standards and compliance certifications](#).

### Operational Resilience

[The AWS global infrastructure](#) has been designed to provide exceptionally high resilience and has the highest network availability of any cloud provider. In fact, AWS has made significant investments in building and running the [world's most resilient cloud](#). AWS Edge locations are also a critical part of AWS global infrastructure and its sovereign-by-design capabilities, allowing customers to provide low-latency, high-performance services to end users around the world, including for [Amazon CloudFront](#), [AWS Firewall Manager](#), [Amazon Route 53](#), [AWS Shield](#), and [AWS Web Application Firewall \(WAF\)](#).

The AWS Cloud spans over one hundred [Availability Zones \(AZs\) within global AWS Regions](#). Each Availability Zone is made up of one or more data centers that contains redundant power, connectivity, and networking. Beyond infrastructure, AWS builds services to be regional whenever possible without any global dependency to help increase the resiliency and autonomy customers get. This enables organizations to respond to and recover from natural disasters, geopolitical influences, or other disruptive events, while ensuring continuity of core functions and services. AWS empowers governments of all sizes to safeguard digital assets. It delivers the highest network availability of any cloud provider and is the only cloud provider to offer three or more AZs in all Regions, providing more redundancy and better isolation to contain issues.

### Data Encryption

AWS is committed to providing customers the ability to encrypt everything everywhere and provides features and controls to encrypt data, whether in transit, at rest, or in memory. These include encryption features with keys managed inside or outside the AWS Cloud. [AWS Key Management Service, \(KMS\)](#) is designed so that no one, including AWS employees, can retrieve plaintext keys from the service. KMS is integrated with 110+ AWS services, making it easier to encrypt the data stores in these services and control access to the keys that decrypt it. [AWS Cloud Hardware Security Module \(CloudHSM\)](#) provides the ability to securely generate, store, and manage cryptographic keys used for data encryption in a way that is only accessible to the customer. To provide customers with more options to store and use their encryption keys on premises or outside of the AWS Cloud, [AWS KMS External Key Store \(XKS\)](#) allows customers to store AWS KMS customer-managed keys on an HSM that can be operated at any location of a customer's choosing.

## Messaging Pillar 2—AWS European Sovereign Cloud

### Messaging Overview

The new AWS European Sovereign Cloud, set to launch in Q4 2025, will offer customers further choice in meeting their digital sovereignty requirements, while helping them to innovate and accelerate where they need to. Designed to complement existing AWS Regions, it is being built in response to the needs of partners and customers in the EU that sit across public sector and highly regulated industries. Physically located within the EU and operated by EU residents that are subject to EU law, the AWS European Sovereign Cloud will help enable customers to run higher-sensitivity workloads and meet stringent EU data residency and regulatory compliance requirements, while getting the same security, availability, and performance they get from existing AWS Regions today.

- **More control and choice without compromise:** AWS provides a broad range of sovereign cloud offerings to help meet customer requirements where they need it. The AWS European Sovereign Cloud will be available as another option for customers to choose from to help them meet their data residency, operational autonomy, and resiliency requirements. Many customers can continue to run most of their workloads and applications and meet their digital sovereignty requirements on existing AWS Regions.
- **Delivering operational autonomy:** The AWS European Sovereign Cloud will support customers that need to meet additional stringent operational autonomy and data residency requirements within the EU, with infrastructure wholly located within the EU and operated independently from existing Regions. To reinforce independent operation of the new sovereign cloud, only personnel who are EU residents and located in the EU will have control of day-to-day operations.
- **Full power of AWS:** The AWS European Sovereign Cloud will be sovereign by design—and will be built on over a decade of experience that AWS has in operating multiple independent clouds for the most critical and restricted workloads. It will be a fully featured cloud that offers the full capacity of AWS including the same familiar architecture, service portfolio, APIs, and security features available in existing AWS Regions.

#### Short Version

Get more choice, meet enhanced EU digital sovereignty needs, and innovate with the AWS European Sovereign Cloud.

#### Medium Version

Get more choice, meet stringent data residency, operational autonomy and resiliency requirements, and run sensitive workloads, while continuing to innovate using the new AWS European Sovereign Cloud—all with the same security, availability, and performance as existing AWS Regions.

#### Long Version

The AWS European Sovereign Cloud offers more choice for EU customers across public sector organizations and highly regulated industries to meet more stringent data residency, operational autonomy, and resiliency requirements, while supporting innovation. Complementing existing AWS Regions and located in the EU, it will be a full featured cloud offering the same security, availability, and performance as existing AWS Regions.

#### Reasons to Believe

##### Ongoing AWS Commitment to Europe

AWS has [invested \\$7.8 billion](#) in the AWS European Sovereign Cloud to help drive positive economic impact, boost innovation, and increase organizational competitiveness across the region. AWS continues to apply learnings from its deep engagements with European regulators and cybersecurity authorities as it builds the AWS European Sovereign Cloud to help ensure it aligns with regional priorities and simplifies customer efforts in meeting such requirements. It will offer the same industry-leading architecture built for security, resilience, and high availability as all other AWS Regions, while remaining separate and independent.



## Operational Autonomy

The [AWS European Sovereign Cloud](#) will be independently operated within the EU and will be physically separate and independent from existing AWS Regions, with separate billing and usage metering systems. The AWS European Sovereign Cloud will give customers the ability to meet stringent operational autonomy and data residency requirements, allowing them to keep all the metadata that they create—such as the roles, permissions, resource labels, and configurations they use to run AWS—in the EU.

All AWS European Sovereign Cloud personnel will be EU residents, subject to EU law, and located in the EU. They will have control of day-to-day operations, including access to data centers, technical support, and customer service.

## Fully Featured Cloud

The AWS European Sovereign Cloud will be a [fully featured cloud](#) that offers the same controls, protections, and assurances as existing Regions, delivered without compromise to the full power of AWS. European customers can run their sensitive workloads using the broadest and deepest portfolio of services available on the AWS European Sovereign Cloud, including AI, analytics, compute, database, Internet of Things (IoT), machine learning, mobile services, and storage, among others.

## Data Residency and Control

The AWS European Sovereign Cloud gives customers in public sector organizations and highly regulated industries further choice to help them meet enhanced data residency needs. Sovereignty is a continuum, and customers can keep their data securely in Europe by deploying to any of the eight existing AWS European Regions in Frankfurt, Ireland, London, Milan, Paris, Stockholm, Spain, and Zurich. AWS customers who need to comply with EU data residency requirements can choose from the six AWS Regions located within the EU today. Customers can begin building sovereign solutions in Europe-based Regions today, and migrate to the AWS European Sovereign Cloud once it launches at the end of 2025 if or when required.

# Messaging Guidelines

## Tenets

### 1. Building Trust

Building trust with customers is fundamental when developing solutions that help address digital sovereignty requirements because of the risks associated with data sensitivity and non-compliance with EU regulations. AWS is committed to providing greater transparency and assurances how services are designed and operated. AWS focuses on explaining the measures and controls that help customers demonstrate their data is protected, privacy is respected, and control of this data remains within the rightful hands.

### 2. Clinical and Empathetic

AWS uses clear and precise language when discussing digital sovereignty topics and clinical language when discussing security topics. When applicable, we include specific examples to illustrate the point. AWS also empathizes with customer concerns. AWS asks probing questions to better

understand and support customers' unique digital sovereignty needs within their technology and immediate regulatory environments.

### 3. Customer-Focused and Realistic

AWS focuses on how customers can succeed and always works backward from their needs. This includes educating customers about the range of available options that can help address their digital sovereignty needs and obligations. AWS is realistic about the geographical location and type of organization that need stringent digital sovereignty measures and avoids applying a one-size-fits-all approach. Each customer has its own unique needs. AWS escalates early and often, obtaining the necessary approvals and driving action with appropriate urgency.

### 4. Actionable and Strategic

AWS suggests actionable digital sovereignty measures that customers can implement immediately. This could include the ability to use existing sovereign-by-design AWS Regions to meet sovereignty needs, as an example. AWS also continues to build for the future. AWS does not cut corners or settle for workarounds and provides strategies that directly improve an organization's long-term innovation and ability to meet digital sovereignty requirements today and in the future.

### 5. Experienced and Empowering

AWS uses its first-hand experience helping customers navigate cloud adoption to provide content that is thoughtful and backed by data. AWS empowers customers to secure their environments with educational content, tools, and services. AWS measures success by the achievements of its customers.

### 6. Global and Accessible

AWS focuses on making sure digital sovereignty content is easily accessible for all customers, ensuring information is inclusive, localized, and reflective of diverse points of view. AWS supports its customers in meeting regulatory compliance challenges based on its direct experience of working with regulatory bodies on a global level for nearly two decades and continues to apply learnings from these deep engagements.

## Best Practices

This messaging guidance outlines the AWS approach to digital sovereignty that AWS Partners can incorporate into their own marketing messaging when communicating their offerings built on, or leveraging the AWS Cloud. All Partner communications and joint marketing campaigns that refer to AWS and digital sovereignty should follow the direction and best practices provided in the guidance below, and have an AWS Partner Marketing Manager approval prior to launch.

## Talking to Customers About AWS and Digital Sovereignty

- **Definitions:** There are varying ways to define the term digital sovereignty. AWS intentionally does not seek to offer a definition, and instead roots conversations in core themes we've distilled down by listening to customers, partners and regulators, including: data residency, operator access restriction, resiliency and survivability, and independence and transparency. Any AWS Partner wishing to define the term in any of their own communications activities, when related to the AWS Cloud, must be clear that this is their own definition and not that of AWS itself.

- **Terminology:** The term “sovereign by design” refers to the AWS approach to digital sovereignty and the foundational design of the AWS Cloud that has made it sovereign since day one. Sovereignty is core to its global infrastructure, services, technical measures, and operational controls—it is not an add on. If using the term, make sure it connects to the origin and foundation of AWS.
- **AWS Digital Sovereignty Pledge:** The AWS campaign slogan for this Pledge is: “More Choice and Control Without Compromise.” When using the slogan itself, it needs to be qualified as representing the AWS commitment of providing the most advanced set of sovereignty controls and security features available in the cloud—which AWS continues to deliver on. Language around Partner digital sovereignty offerings on AWS can and should emphasize the ways that this provides customers with more control and choice generally to connect back to the central theme.
- **FUD Language:** AWS does not support the use of FUD language (wording that elicits fear, uncertainty, and doubt) when talking about AWS or referring to our services in any customer-facing documents or on Partner digital sovereignty landing pages. AWS feels that this type of language does not add any customer value. Any statements using FUD language should be rephrased. For example:
  - **Preferred:** “AWS provides customers with the highest levels of security and protection, while allowing them to innovate at speed.”
  - **Incorrect:** “AWS prevents governments from exploiting data, so organizations are free to innovate.”
- **Target Segments:** When talking about a digital sovereignty offering on AWS, clarify the target customer segments that will benefit from this across the public sector and highly regulated industries. Points can be included how the joint collaboration supports customers in these segments to help reduce complexity and enable them to meet their digital sovereignty requirements.
- **Customer Benefits:** Ensure that all communications are focused on helping customers meet their sovereignty requirements and how your offering on AWS supports them in meeting these needs. Be specific on what your offering is and what it allows customers to do, providing clarity on the measures, controls, or services available and how it will benefit customers.
- **Full Power of the Cloud:** Highlight how your offering on AWS allows customers to benefit from the full power of the cloud, including the highest levels of security, resilience, availability, flexibility, and speed. This further supports the concept that customers do not need to compromise on innovation in order to meet their unique digital sovereignty requirements.

### Talking to Customers About the AWS European Sovereign Cloud

- **AWS Regions vs AWS European Sovereign Cloud:** When talking about an offering on the AWS European Sovereign Cloud, focus on how this offers customers more choice in meeting their digital sovereignty requirements without undermining the sovereignty and security of existing AWS Regions. When talking about differentiators of the AWS European Sovereign Cloud, such as independent operations and the ability to keep metadata that customers create in the EU, connect it to similarities of existing AWS Regions that allows customers to get the same security, availability, and performance. Emphasize that existing AWS Regions are sovereign by design and

support the digital sovereignty needs of most organizations. Also ensure that the AWS European Sovereign Cloud is not presented as being more secure or more compliant with EU regulations, but that it is available as another option to help customers meet their unique needs.

- **Terminology:** Always use the full term “AWS European Sovereign Cloud”. Do not abbreviate to “ESC.”